

Engineering Session Report

SmartEPT Central · 17 August 2026 Trial signup did not provision the client's branded console — investigation, fix, and handover

At a glance

Issue	Self-service 7-day trial clients received no branded console at <code>/<slug></code> ; the slug only appeared after an admin manually re-saved the tenant
Severity	High — affects every self-service trial; first impression of the product for a prospect
Root cause	<code>ProductProvisioner::ensureFor()</code> was never called on the trial signup path
Status	Fixed in the working copy and committed locally · push + test pending with the team
Change size	1 file, +11 lines (1 statement + 9 comment lines), 0 files deleted, 0 migrations, 0 config changes
Deploy risk	Low — idempotent, fail-soft, no schema or data migration
Rollback	<code>git revert</code> of a single commit; no data to unwind
Repo	<code>github.com/ametecsindia/SmartEPT_central</code> · branch <code>fix/trial-console-provisioning</code>

1. Scope of this session

The session began with a single question from Ejaz: a client signs up for the 7-day trial on the landing page, lands in the client portal successfully, but the product has no `/xyz` slug — and re-saving the tenant in admin creates it. Why is it not automatic?

Work carried out:

1. Traced the end-to-end provisioning chain across **both** applications — Central (`C:\laragon\www\smartept-central`) and the product (`C:\laragon\www\smartept / SmartEPT_Admin`).
2. Identified the root cause and ruled out five plausible alternative explanations.
3. Applied the fix to the Central working copy and verified it on disk.
4. Composed the commit against a clean clone of `origin/main` to prove the diff applies cleanly.
5. Produced a root-cause report (`docs/SmartEPT-Trial-Console-Slug-RCA-2026-08-17.md` / `.pdf`).
6. Produced this session report with deployment and test instructions for the team.

2. What exists today — how a console is provisioned

This is the as-is design, unchanged by this session. It is documented here because the defect is only understandable against it, and because the chain crosses two applications.

CENTRAL (smartept-central)	PRODUCT (SmartEPT_Admin)
<pre>ProductProvisioner::ensureFor(\$tenant) guard: deployment === 'cloud' && status IN ('active','trial') └─ POST {product_base_url}/api/provision header X-Provision-Secret: <shared> body: external_tenant_id, company_name, admin_email, admin_name, slug, licence_key, storage_quota_mb, central_url, mail</pre>	<pre>Api\ProvisionController::provision() (no auth guard – the shared secret is the gate) ├─ Company::create([... 'slug' => uniqueSlug()]) ├─ COMPANY_ADMIN user + temp password ├─ adopts Central's SMTP if none set locally ├─ writes the tenant's licence key + validates └─ returns { slug, console_url, temp_password }</pre>
<pre>└─ saves tenants.console_url └─ emails the temporary console password to the client (first provision only)</pre>	

Key properties of `ensureFor()` — all of these were already true and are what make the fix safe:

- **Idempotent.** The product keys on `external_tenant_id`, so a repeat call re-uses the same Company and admin user and merely re-syncs slug, storage quota and licence key.
- **Fail-soft.** Everything is inside `try/catch`; a product outage logs an error and returns. It can never fail or roll back the caller.
- **Silent when unconfigured.** If `product_base_url` or `product_provision_secret` is blank it logs a warning and returns — visible only in the log.
- **Trial-aware.** `'trial'` is explicitly an allowed status.

3. What was found — the defect

`ensureFor()` is the only method in Central that reaches the product. Before this session it had **exactly three callers**, and a self-service trial reaches none of them:

#	Caller	Fires when	Trial?
1	<code>Admin\TenantApiController::store()</code> L143–145	An admin creates a tenant in <code>/admin</code>	✗ The client created it, not an admin
2	<code>Admin\TenantApiController::update()</code> L195–197	An admin saves an existing tenant	✗ Only when someone does it by hand — this was the workaround
3	<code>BillingService::recordPayment()</code> L683	A payment is recorded	✗ A free trial takes no money, so no order settles

The self-service path (`POST /client/signup/verify` → `Client\AuthController::signupVerify()`) creates the tenant with `deployment => 'cloud'` and `status => 'trial'` — both correct — then calls `BillingService::provisionTrial()`, which sets the trial dates and issues the licence and **stops there**. `BillingService` even holds a `ProductProvisioner $console` in its constructor; it is simply not used on the trial branch.

Ruled out (each would have sent a fix in the wrong direction):

- The `trial` status is not filtered out — it is explicitly allowed.
- `deployment` is set correctly at signup.
- A blank `console_slug` is not fatal — there is a `Str::slug(company_name)` fallback.
- `ensureFor()` is not once-only — it is deliberately re-runnable.

- Not a settings problem — if the URL/secret were blank, the admin re-save would fail too.

4. What was fixed

File: `app/Http/Controllers/Client/AuthController.php` — one statement added immediately after the signup transaction commits (now lines 136–145).

```
});

// ROOT-CAUSE FIX (Ejaz, 17-Aug-2026): a self-service trial never reached the
// product app, so the client had NO branded console at /<slug> until an admin
// opened the tenant and pressed Save. ensureFor() was wired only to
// TenantApiController (admin create/save) and BillingService::recordPayment()
// – and a free trial records no payment. Stand the console up here instead.
// Post-commit on purpose: provisioning is an 8s HTTP round trip and must not
// be held open inside the signup transaction. Idempotent and fail-soft
// (ensureFor swallows + logs), so a product outage still leaves a working
// trial and the admin Save stays available as the recovery path.
app(\App\Services\ProductProvisioner::class)->ensureFor($user->tenant()->first());

Auth::guard('client')->login($user, true);
```

Why after the transaction, not inside `provisionTrial()` . Putting the call in `BillingService::provisionTrial()` would be tidier and would cover any future trial path automatically. It was rejected for one reason: `provisionTrial()` runs inside `DB::transaction` , and `ensureFor()` makes an HTTP call with an 8-second timeout. Holding a write transaction open across a network round trip to a second application — one that may be slow, down, or firewalled — is a bad trade. Post-commit placement gets the same outcome with none of that exposure.

What did NOT change: no database schema, no migration, no configuration, no product-side code, no billing logic, no existing call site. Nothing was deleted.

5. What was improved beyond the fix

Area	Improvement
Client experience	The console credentials email (product temp password) now reaches the client during signup, instead of whenever an admin happened to press Save
Traceability	The fix carries a 9-line comment explaining the failure, the three original call sites, and why the placement is what it is — so the next reader does not re-derive it
Documentation	A full root-cause report added at <code>docs/SmartEPT-Trial-Console-Slug-RCA-2026-08-17.md</code> (+ PDF), following the existing <code>docs/</code> naming convention
Commit quality	The commit message records the symptom, the three call sites, the reasoning for the placement, and the ruled-out causes
Verified clean base	The change was diffed against <code>origin/main</code> before committing — proving no unrelated local edits were swept in
Backfill path identified	A SQL query that lists exactly the affected existing tenants (\$8)

6. Impact

Before the fix

Who	Effect
Trial client	Signed up, reached the portal, then found no console to actually try the product. Never received console credentials. The trial clock ran while they waited
Sales	Had to notice the new trial and ask someone to open <code>/admin</code> and press Save before the prospect could evaluate anything
Support / admin	A silent manual step, invisible unless someone knew to look — no error, no alert, nothing in the UI to indicate the console was missing
Product	<code>tenants.console_url</code> stayed null, so "Open my Console" and portal SSO had no target

After the fix

Who	Effect
Trial client	Console exists and is reachable at <code>/<slug></code> from the moment signup completes; credentials email arrives in the same minute
Sales	Zero-touch trial. A prospect self-serves end to end
Support / admin	The admin Save remains as a recovery path if the product app was down at signup

Residual exposure

Every trial that signed up **before** this fix is still missing its console. Those tenants need either a manual admin Save each or the backfill in §8. This is the only remaining customer-facing gap from this defect.

7. Deployment instructions

Environment: SmartEPT Central. **Prerequisite:** Central → Settings → SmartEPT Product must have `product_base_url` and `product_provision_secret` populated. If they are blank the fix runs but does nothing (and logs a warning) — verify this first.

The working copy at `C:\laragon\www\smartept-central` is already patched. The commit message is staged at `storage/app/trial-console-fix.commit.txt` (Laravel gitignores `storage/`).

Step 1 — commit and push

```
cd C:\laragon\www\smartept-central
git status                    # confirm only AuthController.php is intended
git checkout -b fix/trial-console-provisioning
git add app/Http/Controllers/Client/AuthController.php
git commit -F storage/app/trial-console-fix.commit.txt
git push -u origin fix/trial-console-provisioning
```

Omit the `checkout -b` line to land directly on `main`, as recent commits do. The `git add` is deliberately scoped to the one file — other work in progress may be present.

Backup route: a `trial-console-fix.patch` (`git format-patch`) was also provided. To use it: `git checkout app/Http/Controllers/Client/AuthController.php` then `git am trial-console-fix.patch`.

Step 2 — review and merge

Single-file diff, +11 lines. Reviewer should confirm the call sits **after** the closing `});` of `DB::transaction` and **before** `Auth::guard('client')->login(...)`.

Step 3 — deploy to the server

```
git pull
php artisan config:clear
php artisan cache:clear
php artisan optimize
```

No migration. No queue worker restart required (the call is synchronous). No product-side deploy.

Step 4 — post-deploy smoke test

Run test case **T1** below on the live site with an internal email address, then delete or mark that tenant as internal.

8. Backfill for existing affected trials

Run the query first — it tells you whether this is a handful of manual Saves or worth automating.

```
SELECT id, company_name, email, status, created_at
FROM tenants
WHERE deployment = 'cloud'
  AND status IN ('active','trial')
  AND (console_url IS NULL OR console_url = '')
ORDER BY created_at DESC;
```

- **A few rows:** open each tenant in `/admin` and press Save. Done.
- **Many rows:** an artisan command looping that query and calling `ensureFor()` on each is roughly fifteen lines and is safe to re-run. Ask and it will be written.

Important: provisioning a backfilled tenant is a *first* provision, so the product returns a temporary password and Central emails it to that client. This is correct behaviour, but it is outbound mail to real customers — do it deliberately, during working hours, not as an unattended sweep. Consider notifying sales first so they expect the client replies.

9. Test plan

Environment: Central + product both reachable; `product_base_url` and `product_provision_secret` configured. Watch `storage/logs/laravel.log` on Central throughout.

ID	Area	Steps	Expected result	Pass
T1	Trial signup — the fix	Sign up a new 7-day trial from the landing page using an email not present in <code>tenant_users</code> . Complete OTP	Signup succeeds; log shows <code>Cloud console provisioned</code> with a <code>console_url</code> ; <code>tenants.console_url</code> populated	☐
T2	Slug reachability	Open the <code>console_url</code> from T1	The branded console loads at <code>/<slug></code> — no 404	☐
T3	Credentials email	Check the T1 inbox	Email "Your SmartEPT console sign-in" received with a temporary password; log shows <code>Console credentials emailed to tenant owner</code>	☐
T4	Forced password change	Sign in to the console with the T1 temp password	Product forces a password change on first sign-in (<code>must_change_password</code>)	☐
T5	Portal SSO	From the client portal, click "Open my Console"	Lands signed in, no second password prompt	☐
T6	Idempotency	Open the T1 tenant in <code>/admin</code> and press Save	No duplicate company or user is created; slug unchanged; no second credentials email	☐
T7	Regression — admin create	Create a cloud tenant manually in <code>/admin</code>	Console provisioned exactly as before this change	☐
T8	Regression — paid order	Record a payment against a cloud order	Console provisioned exactly as before this change	☐
T9	Fail-soft — product down	Stop the product app (or blank <code>product_base_url</code>), then sign up a trial	Signup still succeeds, client still reaches the portal, trial licence still issued; log shows the provisioning error/warning only	☐
T10	Recovery after T9	Restart the product, open that tenant in <code>/admin</code> , press Save	Console provisioned; <code>console_url</code> fills in	☐
T11	Duplicate email guard	Attempt a second trial signup with the T1 email	Rejected with "This email already has a SmartEPT account" — unchanged behaviour	☐
T12	Existing tests	<code>php artisan test</code> (or <code>test.bat</code>)	No new failures versus the pre-change baseline	☐

T9 is the important one. It proves the fix cannot damage a signup when the product is unavailable — the property that justifies making this call synchronously inside the signup request.

Sign-off

Role	Name	Date	Result
Developer			
Tester			
Approved by			

10. Risk and rollback

Risk	Assessment
Signup breaks if the product is down	Mitigated — <code>ensureFor()</code> is fail-soft; covered by T9
Signup slows down	Up to 8s worst case (HTTP timeout) added to the signup request, and only when the product is unreachable. Normal case is well under a second
Duplicate companies / users	Not possible — the product is idempotent on <code>external_tenant_id</code> ; covered by T6
Duplicate credential emails	Not possible — <code>temp_password</code> is returned only on first provision
Data loss	None — no schema, migration or destructive operation

Rollback: `git revert <commit>` and redeploy. Behaviour returns to admin-Save-only, and any console already provisioned stays provisioned and working.

11. Open items

#	Item	Owner	Priority
1	Push the branch and merge (§7 Step 1)	Dev	Now
2	Confirm <code>product_base_url</code> + <code>product_provision_secret</code> are set in Central Settings	Dev / Ops	Before testing
3	Execute the test plan (§9), especially T9	Tester	With the deploy
4	Run the backfill query and decide manual vs command (§8)	Ejaz	This week
5	Audit other cloud-tenant creation paths (prospect quotes, plan changes) for the same missing call	Dev	Next session — not covered by this session
6	Consider moving the call into <code>provisionTrial()</code> if a second trial path is ever added	Dev	Backlog

Appendix A — evidence trail

File	Lines	What it shows
Central: <code>app/Http/Controllers/Client/AuthController.php</code>	67, 108–134	Trial signup path; tenant created cloud/trial; only <code>provisionTrial()</code> called
Central: <code>app/Services/BillingService.php</code>	32, 683, 1043	<code>ProductProvisioner</code> injected; called on payment; not called in <code>provisionTrial()</code>
Central: <code>app/Http/Controllers/Admin/TenantApiController.php</code>	143–145, 195–197	The two admin call sites — why the manual Save worked
Central: <code>app/Services/ProductProvisioner.php</code>	25–115	<code>ensureFor()</code> : cloud+trial guard, slug fallback, idempotency, fail-soft try/catch
Central: <code>routes/web.php</code>	31	<code>POST /client/signup/verify</code> → <code>signupVerify</code>
Product: <code>app/Http/Controllers/Api/ProvisionController.php</code>	—	Receives the call; <code>Company::create</code> with <code>uniqueSlug()</code> ; returns <code>console_url</code>
Product: <code>database/migrations/2026_08_04_000100_add_slug_to_companies.php</code>	—	<code>companies.slug</code> , nullable + unique

Appendix B — environment notes for the team

- **Live working copies:** Central `C:\laragon\www\smartept-central` → `ameteccsindia/SmartEPT_central` ; Product `C:\laragon\www\smartept` → `ameteccsindia/SmartEPT_Admin` . Both are git clones on `main` .
- **Do not use** `Documents\Claude\Projects\SmartEPT` as a source — it is a snapshot with no `.git` , roughly a month behind, and its `central/` copy does not even contain `ProductProvisioner.php` .
- **Baseline for this work:** Central `origin/main @ 97e4b52` ("17-08-2026 update 1").
- The commit was authored in this session but **could not be pushed** from it — the sandbox git proxy declines credentials for repositories not attached as session sources. The push is a human step (§7).

Appendix C — deliverables from this session

File	Location
Patched source	<code>app/Http/Controllers/Client/AuthController.php</code>
Commit message	<code>storage/app/trial-console-fix.commit.txt</code>
Standalone patch	<code>trial-console-fix.patch</code> (delivered in chat)
Root-cause report	<code>docs/SmartEPT-Trial-Console-Slug-RCA-2026-08-17.md</code> + <code>.pdf</code>
This session report	<code>docs/SmartEPT-Session-Report-2026-08-17.md</code> + <code>.pdf</code>